S27: Does the effect of a conciliatory message on willingness to reconcile depend on role?

Question. Do victims become more willing to reconcile after an *empowerment* message (praise of competence) than after an *acceptance* message (affirmation as a moral person), with perpetrators showing the reverse, i.e. a crossover role x message interaction?

Data and sample. Independent replication, SPSS file `d05.sav` (146 rows; the CSV twin has the same rows). Design: 2 (role: victim / perpetrator) x 2 (message: acceptance / empowerment), between subjects. No exclusions by rule. Rows missing the after-message willingness score or a condition code were dropped listwise: 5 rows (2 lacked condition codes, and these were among the 5 lacking the outcome), leaving **N = 141**.

Measure. `AvgWillingReconcileTime2`, the mean of ten 7-point items after the message (higher = more willing). The stored score equals the mean of the ten stored item columns exactly; Cronbach's alpha = .92 (n = 135 with all items).

Plan (fixed before analysis, see log.md). Primary test: between-subjects 2 x 2 ANOVA (Type III SS), role x message interaction, with partial eta squared and a 95% CI. The claim holds only if the interaction has $p < .05$ **and** the cell means show the predicted signs (victims: empowerment > acceptance; perpetrators: acceptance > empowerment).

Results

Role	Message	n	Mean	SD
Victim	Acceptance	33	4.08	1.35
Victim	Empowerment	34	3.87	1.26
Perpetrator	Acceptance	37	4.86	1.11
Perpetrator	Empowerment	37	5.11	0.83

Primary test: role x message interaction, F(1, 137) = 1.42, p = .235, partial eta squared = .010, 95% CI [.000, .067].

The pattern also runs the *opposite* way to the prediction: victims were slightly more willing after acceptance than after empowerment (difference -0.21, pooled-error t(137) = -0.77, p = .44, d = -0.17), and perpetrators slightly more willing after empowerment than after acceptance (+0.25, t(137) = 0.93, p = .36, d = 0.25). Neither simple effect is reliable.

Other terms: a large main effect of role (perpetrators more willing than victims, F(1, 137) = 27.4, p < .001); no main effect of message (F(1, 137) = 0.01, p = .93).

Robustness. Type II SS gives the same interaction (F = 1.42, p = .235). A heteroskedasticity-robust (HC3) test of the interaction coefficient: z = -1.16, p = .25. Levene's test: p = .10. Mann-Whitney tests of message within each role: p = .47 (victims), p = .45 (perpetrators). Adjusting

for before-message willingness (ANCOVA): interaction $F(1, 136) = 0.15$, $p = .70$. Gains from before to after the message were nearly identical across messages within each role (victims +0.59 vs +0.65; perpetrators +0.94 vs +0.98).

Conclusion

The claim does not hold on this data: the role x message interaction is small and not significant ($F(1, 137) = 1.42$, $p = .235$, partial eta squared = .010), and the cell means point in the direction opposite to the predicted crossover.

Limits. With about 35 per cell the study can detect only moderate interactions (the 95% CI reaches partial eta squared = .067), so a small effect in the predicted direction cannot be ruled out; but the point estimate is in the wrong direction. Files: `analysis.py` produces every number above; output in `analysis.out`.